Project Documentation Package

Support Tier Demarcation:

PMS Integration Case Flow Restructuring

Document Type	Project Documentation Package
Product	EchoCRS — PMS Integration Support
Project Lead	Support Engineering / L2 Operations
Audience	Support Leadership, L1 & L2 Teams, Training
Scope	Global — Americas, EMEA, APAC
Documents	Project Plan · Case Progression SOP · Status Report
Version	1.0 — EOY Status

About This Package

This package consolidates the project documentation produced for the EchoCRS Support Tier Demarcation initiative — a global effort to restructure how PMS integration support cases are triaged, escalated, and resolved across L1 and L2 support tiers.

Prior to this initiative, PMS Connect cases were handled inconsistently across global support teams, with L2 resources absorbing a disproportionate share of cases that could be resolved at the L1 tier with proper tooling, documentation, and escalation criteria. The demarcation project established clear tier boundaries, revised escalation templates, built a centralized knowledge resource in SharePoint, and delivered structured training and knowledge transfer programs to L1 teams across all regions.

The three documents in this package represent the full project lifecycle: the original project plan with goals and timeline, the operational SOP governing case progression between tiers, and the end-of-year status report documenting outcomes, challenges, and remaining work.

> **ℹ Note**
> - All proprietary identifiers, real names, and internal system URLs have been removed or replaced for portfolio presentation. Tool names (Kibana, Splunk, Salesforce) are retained as they are industry-standard platforms.
> - This package is presented as-produced — reflecting the working documentation style used during an active project rather than a fully polished post-project retrospective.

Doc	Title	Purpose
1	**Project Plan & Goals**	Defines the initiative scope, project goals, and training strategy. Establishes the case flow expectations for each support tier.

2	**Case Escalation & Tier SOP**	Operational procedure governing when and how cases progress between T1 and T2, including documentation requirements and tier responsibility boundaries.
3	**End-of-Year Status Report**	Project status at EOY: completed deliverables, ongoing tasks, regional progress, successes, and challenges overcome.

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Project Plan & Goals

1. Project Overview

This project establishes formal tier demarcation for PMS integration support cases, transitioning appropriate case types from L2 to L1 support teams. The initiative ensures cases are handled by the correct support tier, improving resolution efficiency and freeing L2 resources for knowledge development, defect escalation, and project delivery.

- Brings product and process flow into alignment across global L2 support teams.
- Allows L2 Support to focus on knowledge documentation development and project delivery.
- Increases L2 visibility to better champion system defects and enhancements.

2. Project Goals

Case Identification & Reporting

- Create and review Salesforce reporting to identify resources and case volume.
- Identify case types eligible for demarcation.
- Evaluate case types to determine additional fields needed for structured troubleshooting prior to escalation.

Global Engagement & Distribution

- Acquire global engagement and approval across all regions.
- Distribute demarcation guidelines globally.
- Place all materials within SharePoint for global access.

End-to-End Case Flow — L1 Tier Expectations

L1/T1 process prior to escalation to L1/T2:

  - Begin investigation using Kibana to validate reported issues.
  - Apply troubleshooting methods based on available documentation.
  - Collaborate with L1/T1 team and consult L1/T2 Support as needed.

L1/T2 process prior to escalation to L3 Technical Teams:

  - Validate T1 findings.
  - Apply additional advanced troubleshooting methods.

- Collaborate with L1/T2 team and consult L2 Support via Teams and Knowledge Transfer meetings.

L1 Training & Knowledge Development

- Create and review Salesforce dashboard to identify knowledge gaps for product training.
- Identify trending issues for documentation and training delivery.
- Conduct case review analysis during Knowledge Transfer meetings.
- Identify coaching opportunities — minimum 3x per week.
- Hold quarterly meetings with L1 Leadership to relay process and product improvement opportunities.
- Conduct individual agent knowledge evaluations and collect feedback on knowledge gaps.
- Collaborate with L1 Leadership to align training schedule and develop training documentation for SharePoint delivery.
- Develop standard operating procedures (SOPs) as needed.

3. Project Timeline

Period	Milestone / Deliverable
January 202X	Case identification for demarcation completed. Escalation templates revised and distributed globally.
February 202X	Initiate redirect of L1/T1 PMS integration case flow to demarcated model.
March 202X	Deliver tier support expectations to L1 Leadership. Identify areas for documentation development to address L1/T1 knowledge gaps.
April 202X	Quarterly review with L1 Leadership. Knowledge gap identification for focused training of L1/T2.
July 202X	Quarterly review with L1 Leadership. Action any requests for additional coaching and documentation for L1 Support.
August 202X	L1/T2 training delivered by PMS integration L2 team as needed.
October 202X	Quarterly review with L1 Leadership.
December 202X	Analysis of L1/T2 knowledge based on training and documentation efforts completed to date.
January 202X+1	Final quarterly review with L1 Leadership — enter steady state. Transition from L2-led PMS integration case work to L1/T2 ownership.

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Case Escalation & Tier SOP

This document defines the operational procedure for progressing support cases between Tier 1 and Tier 2 within the EchoCRS PMS integration support model. It establishes escalation triggers, documentation requirements, and tier-level responsibilities.

Case Progression Triggers

A case is eligible for progression from T1 to T2 when any of the following conditions are met:

#	Trigger Condition
1	T1 has exhausted all available tools for investigation, troubleshooting, and customer support — including knowledge base resources, support chat, and peer consultation.
2	The case has 3 or more client interactions, OR has been assigned to the agent for 5 or more business days without resolution.
3	The case status is: Paused – Parent Case Escalated, or Paused – Development Team Review.

Case Progression Steps

T1 Agent — Before Escalation

- Document the issue fully in case comments: include troubleshooting steps taken, screenshots, and all relevant information. Use the appropriate escalation template (available on SharePoint).
- Change the Case Product Line to reflect PMS integration and send client communication advising the case will be transitioned to a senior product specialist for further review.
- Change the Case Owner to the T2 support queue.

T2 Agent — Upon Receipt

If the case meets all progression requirements:

- Notify the client that T2 has taken ownership and will be conducting further review.

If the case does not meet progression requirements:

- Notify the previous case owner via case chatter, clarifying what is missing. Tag the corresponding supervisor for visibility.
- Reassign the case back to the T1 agent.
- Once missing information is provided, the case may be assigned directly back to the T2 agent who gave feedback.

Tier Responsibility Matrix

The following table defines the scope and responsibilities for each support tier under the demarcated model:

Tier	Responsibilities & Scope
L1 / T1	• PMS integration investigations, including Kibana XML log searches. • Validating reported discrepancies and connectivity issues. • Applying documented troubleshooting steps before escalation. • Maintaining case documentation standards required for T2 progression.
L1 / T2	• PMS vendor conference calls and advanced/complex troubleshooting. • Processing issues involving errors, corrupted XML, and message-level failures.

	• Project cases based on high complexity, client sensitivity, or level of effort (LOE). • Development cases: consulting with L2 SMEs and packaging for L3 escalation. • Cases outside T1 scope due to access limitations, time constraints, or depth of investigation required.
L2	• Quality assurance of L1 cases. • Defect and enhancement prioritization. • User acceptance testing (UAT). • Guidance, coaching, and knowledge transfer to L1 tiers. • Beta case handling as directed by leadership.

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End-of-Year Status Report

Report Date	30 November — End of Year
Project	Support Tier Demarcation
Status	In Progress — AMER Complete, EMEA/APAC Ongoing

Completed Deliverables

Case Analysis & Documentation Foundation

- ✓ ~~Case identification and audit completed for demarcation eligibility.~~
- ✓ ~~L1 support knowledge gaps identified through case audit.~~
- ✓ ~~L1 support expectations documented and delivered to L1 leadership.~~
- ✓ ~~End-to-end case flow process documented.~~

SharePoint & Tooling

- ✓ ~~SharePoint foundation built, presented, and distributed to L1 Support.~~
- ✓ ~~Troubleshooting Quick Notes and Video Shorts pages established.~~
- ✓ ~~Salesforce module and component defined and delivered; loaded to SharePoint.~~
- ✓ ~~Escalation templates revised and distributed globally; loaded to SharePoint.~~

Knowledge Transfer & Communication

- ✓ ~~PMSC knowledge transfer meetings initiated for Americas region.~~
- ✓ ~~Dedicated support chat established for direct communication between AMER L1 and L2 teams.~~
- ✓ ~~Unified request templates created across products; automation built for L1 to request L2 assistance.~~
- ✓ ~~Coaching notes delivered to L1 leadership.~~

Ongoing Tasks

- Review knowledge gap trends with L1 leadership to assess adjustments needed for training outlook.
- Continue developing Quick Note documentation topics to bridge identified knowledge gaps.

Pending Items

SOP Development

- Create SOP for identifying support cases vs. implementation cases.
- Status: Stalled — pending collaboration between L2 Support, Implementation, and CSMs. CSMs to take lead; no delivery to Implementation/Support as of report date.

Global Alignment

- International teams (EMEA) have not yet moved forward with demarcation of support from delivery.
- Next steps: preparing documentation for Phase 2 — EMEA demarcation.
- EMEA implementation support will take back seat to new business, contributing to case backlog and customer experience impact.
- APAC is currently demarcating — working more closely with APAC team; requested documentation in development.

Regional Status at a Glance

Region	Status	Notes
Americas (AMER)	**Complete**	Demarcation complete. Knowledge transfers shifted to as-needed basis. Dedicated chat remains in place.
Asia-Pacific (APAC)	**In Progress**	Actively demarcating. Collaboration underway; documentation support being developed.
EMEA	**Pending**	Not yet started. Phase 2 documentation in preparation. New business priority is a contributing factor to delay.
Global	**In Progress**	Templates and SharePoint distributed globally. Alignment on end-to-end case flow pending for international teams.

✓ **Successes**

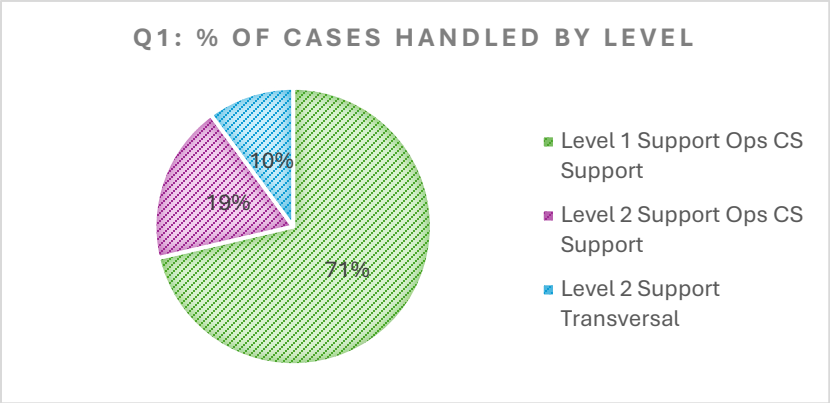
- SharePoint built and distributed ahead of schedule — cross-team collaboration allowed documentation and the platform to materialize quickly.
- Introduction of APAC collaboration established ahead of formal Phase 2 planning.
- Knowledge transfer meetings and dedicated chat proved highly effective — meetings reduced from 2x/week to 1x/week to on-demand within the same quarter, reflecting rapid L1 capability growth.
- Automation for L1-to-L2 assistance requests created — enables better trend tracking, protects coaching notes, and allows documentation links to be recorded alongside responses.

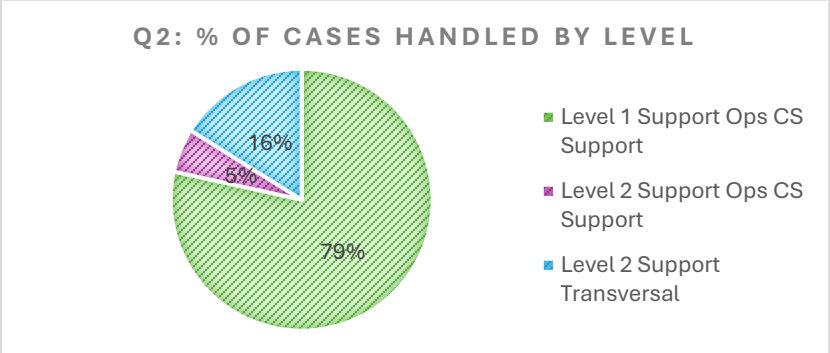
Challenges Overcome

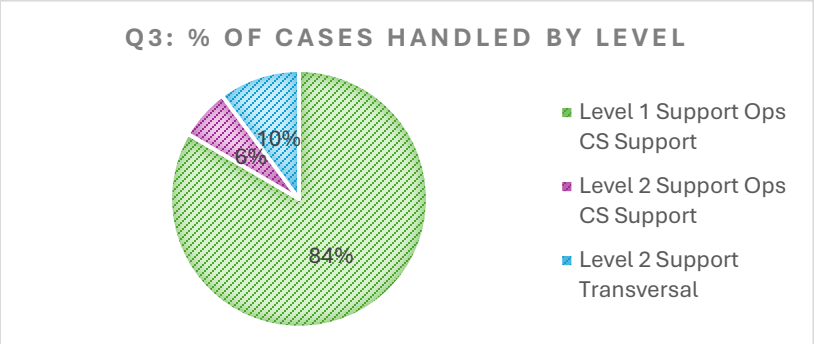
- Baseline goal adjustments required quarter-to-quarter due to shifts in L1 structure, overall case handling patterns, and inconsistent case tagging in Salesforce. Demarcation continued to progress despite these structural changes.
- Despite Salesforce module definitions being delivered, case tagging remained inconsistent, skewing reporting numbers. Resolution: shifted data collection to a combined methodology using components, deployment instances, and articles attached to cases for a more accurate view of case handling.

Demarcation Progress — Data

Global:







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